

CA 610. Communication Technologies & Culture

Spring Semester 2021

Instructor: Dr. Jeffrey Klenotic

Class Meetings: Tuesdays 1-3:50. **Location:** Section M1: Room P380; Section M2: Select "Zoom" in the Canvas menu; click "Join" next to the appropriate meeting ID number to participate synchronously.

Class Recordings: Because of the need to accommodate potential isolation and quarantine due to the COVID pandemic, lectures or other class meetings for this course may be recorded by the university using UNH media platforms. Such recordings may be available for educational use by students enrolled in the class (including both for instruction and as a review tool), the course instructor(s), and other university officials who support course instruction. Your voice or image may be captured on the recordings, and by enrolling in this course you are consenting to such recording for these purposes. UNH and Zoom have FERPA-compliant agreements in place to protect the security and privacy of UNH Zoom accounts. **You may not share recordings outside of this class.** Doing so may result in disciplinary action. **To review recorded class sessions, select "Media Gallery,"** use your UNH user name and password to login to Kaltura video, and then click on the class session that you wish to watch. Be aware that there may be a delay of a few days before videos post to Canvas.

Office Hours: T 4-5; Th 5-6 & by appointment. Note: **UNH policy for spring 2021 prohibits in person office visits.** Students wishing to meet with me during office hours can do so via Zoom in the Canvas menu (click "Join" next to the "Office Hours" meeting ID number).

Contact: Phone: (603) 641-4130, Email: jeffrey.klenotic@unh.edu

Course Description: A broad definition of culture would be that it is the symbolic process we use to learn about and organize our world. It is through culture that we give meaning, value, order, and a measure of predictability to the flux of objects, experiences, and interactions that make up daily life. This seminar investigates the influence of information and communication technologies on culture. To do this, we undertake a philosophical and historical examination of changing media practices and consider their impact on human values, behaviors and social relations; the structure of thought and knowledge in the public sphere; the nature of privacy, work, and the economy; and the boundaries between humans and machines, among other topics.

Course Objectives: By taking this course, students will develop conceptual abilities, historical knowledge, and critical thinking skills that will enable them to:

- 1) *Know about the intellectual history of communication, technology, and culture as concepts.*
- 2) *Understand the theoretical connections between communication technologies and culture.*
- 3) *Identify key eras and revolutions in the history of communication technologies and culture.*
- 4) *Explain how communication technologies shape culture and alter the nature of human relations.*

Course Attributes: CA 610 fills one of two required "Area C: Theory and Research" courses in the Communication Arts Major. It can also be used to satisfy the "Area III" requirement in the CA Digital Media Option and the CA Advertising and Public Relations Option. This course is officially designated "**writing intensive**" and will count toward the UNH Writing Intensive Discovery requirements. While CA 610 is not

officially classified as a Discovery "capstone" course, **Communication Arts majors in their senior year who wish to use this course to satisfy the capstone requirement may seek permission to do so.** **Students who seek to do so should notify me promptly so that we can begin the planning process.** Once we have agreed on a plan, I will write an email stating that CA 610 may be used to satisfy your capstone requirement. This email will be shared with your academic advisor to be placed in your advising folder. As stated in the UNH Catalogue, CA majors seeking to satisfy the capstone requirement must "synthesize and apply knowledge and skills gained throughout their communication arts major coursework. The capstone course requires students to conduct an original research study, a creative media project, an internship, community-based research, or an advanced service-learning project in communication arts under the close supervision of a communication arts faculty member." Students who wish to use this course to design a capstone project may do so by working with me to develop an idea that "synthesizes" their knowledge and skills and "applies" these capacities to understand or illuminate some dimension of "communication technologies and culture" as a field of research. Such a project could take many forms. It could, for example, involve applying knowledge and skills to better understand the dynamics of your own personal or family experience, your work experience, or your experience of public or social life. It could also mean working with a business or organization in the community to collect data and analyze it in ways that solve a problem and extend your own learning to benefit the business or organization at the same time. Another option might be to conduct an original research or creative project that does primary source research and/or develops a new theory or model of communication technologies and culture.

Course Credit Hours: 4 credits. **This syllabus reflects the federal definition of a credit hour.** Federal regulations define the amount of effort (which includes attending/reviewing lectures, doing readings, viewing films, completing assignments, preparing presentations, etc.) students should commit to their classes as follows: 3 hours of work per week per credit over a 14-week semester. **The expected effort for a semester-long 4-credit course is 12 hours/week** (4 credits x 3 hours/credit).

Course Website: This course makes regular and active use of a Canvas website. If you do not have a UNH username and password, please visit the IT office soon to set up an account.

Required Books (in alphabetical order):

1. William Ammerman, ***The Invisible Brand: Marketing in the Age of Big Data, Automation, and Machine Learning***, 2019, ISBN: 9781260441260 [*TIB* in reading schedule], [full text available](#) via UNH library (login required).
2. Brooke Erin Duffy, ***(Not) Getting Paid to Do What You Love: Gender, Social Media, and Aspirational Work***, 2017, ISBN: 9780300218176 [*NGP* in reading schedule], [full text available](#) via UNH library (login required)
3. Neil Postman, ***Amusing Ourselves to Death: Public Discourse in the Age of Show Business***, 2015, ISBN: 9780143036531 [*AOD* in reading schedule], [full text available](#)
4. *Debora L. Spar, ***Work Mate Marry Love: How Machines Shape Our Human Destiny***, 2020, ISBN: 9780374200039 [*WMML* in reading schedule] ***Not available on Canvas; must be purchased.**

Alongside these books, we will use **additional readings** made available on Canvas. **To access these readings, CLICK ON THE TITLE as it is listed in the Course Outline** and Reading Schedule and you will be taken directly to the reading. All readings are required and should be completed *before* the date scheduled. Class discussion will emanate directly from readings, and it will be vital that you have read the material so you can contribute thoughtfully to discussion.

Class Format: This is an **advanced seminar**. A seminar is a small group of people who have a sustained series of conversations based on readings relating to an important topic. As an advanced seminar, **our readings and writing assignments offer a glimpse of what graduate study in this field might entail and help to prepare**

you for such work. The word “seminar” derives from *seminarium*, which translates to “a nursery or hotbed” (*Century Dictionary and Cyclopedia*). As such, a seminar is a hotbed for ideas, a place for thinking rigorously, critically, and creatively about the past and present to produce insights that may feed the future. Each seminar session will begin promptly at 1 PM and end at 3:50 PM. Every effort will be made to provide a full 10-15 minute break every class so that you can stretch your legs and grab a snack.

Class Conduct and Netiquette Guidelines: Students are expected to come to class having completed all assigned readings and ready to share their thoughts and views on the material. Active participation during discussions is expected and required. The main requirement is that you contribute **informed comments and pertinent questions, keep an open mind, and give attention and respect to the thoughts expressed by others in the class**, especially those with whom you may disagree. It is important to let everyone have a chance at speaking and presenting ideas in this course – in fact its small size is designed for that. It is a rare opportunity in which everyone’s point of view matters. Productive discussions are based on arguments that rely on evidence (e.g., specific passages from readings, from films we watch, research sources, etc.). This course is fully aligned with UNH’s code of conduct, which seeks to make both the in-person and online classroom a welcoming space for diverse voices in the discussion of intellectual ideas and research. As part of this culture of respect, please refrain from making assumptions about other people’s identities, beliefs, ideas, etc. Threatening or harassing behavior will not be tolerated. **Netiquette is the socially and professionally acceptable way to communicate on the Internet.** Please abide by these guidelines of netiquette when using online communication tools with your classmates and instructor. In Zoom or video conferences:

- Turn on your camera when your network bandwidth and learning space allows. Facial expressions and body language are an important part of communicating.
- Connect at least a few minutes early.
- Remove clutter or personal items around you.
- Avoid background noise.
- Consider using a headset to reduce distractions.
- Keep your device (phone, computer, etc.) on mute unless you are speaking.
- Speak clearly, but not too loudly.
- Don't abuse the chat box, keep the conversation respectful and on topic.
- Remember that a video conference has the same degree of respect as a live class, consider your appearance behavior on camera the same you would in the classroom.

Use of Electronic Devices During Class: During class (both in person and online), we will not make use of any media technology or internet platform unless this is specifically required for class instruction and/or related learning activities. This policy is in keeping with [section 04:213 of the Student Handbook](#): “Regarding the policy on cell phone/PDA/pager/digital music player/laptop/other electronic device use during class, students may not use cell phones, PDAs, pagers, digital music players, laptops and other electronic devices during class unless designated by the course instructor. If use of any of these items is permitted by the course instructor, these items are not allowed to be used for non-class activities. If you, the student, have a learning disability that requires the use of one of these items, you must provide evidence from the Disability Services for Students office, to inform the course instructor of this situation so that he or she can accommodate your use. Also, if you need to leave a cell phone on for an emergency situation, you should inform the instructor at the beginning of the class session as well as keep the phone on in a silent mode, so as not to disrupt the course (p. 23).”

PPE and Social Distancing Policies for In-Person Instruction: UNH policy requires all students to wear masks in class and campus buildings unless a medical exception is made through an accommodation process. It is your responsibility to obtain a mask before coming to class. For information on proper mask use, acceptable mask types, and other PPE and social distancing guidelines visit <https://www.unh.edu/coronavirus>. Students wishing to request a medical accommodation should contact [Student Accessibility Services](#). Failure to comply with PPE

and social distancing classroom protocols is a violation of the [Student Rights, Rules & Responsibilities](#). If you refuse to comply, you will be asked to leave class immediately and you may also be reported to the Office of the Dean of Students and your associate dean.

Prior to class, please wait outside the building, weather permitting, or in the hall or common area, observing social distancing and leaving plenty of room for the prior class to exit the room and building. Wipes are available near the room entrance. Obey entrance and egress signage and any additional faculty directions on entering or leaving the classroom. Sit only in marked seats. Classes and laboratories were restructured to minimize or eliminate contact between individuals of less than 6 feet. Each classroom entrance is equipped with hand sanitizer and surface wipes.

- Use hand sanitizer as you deem appropriate.
- Wipe down your personal space prior to class and throw used wipes away on the way out of class or take them with you.

Contract tracing is mandated by the State of New Hampshire. The following practices will facilitate effective contact tracing implementation should the need arise:

- Students should sit in the same seat for each class period to minimize potential contacts.
- We ask students to know the names of each of the people sitting closest to them.

UNH has developed "Wildcat Pass," a web and mobile app to help each of us keep track of the requirements for being in compliance with necessary testing, isolation and quarantine rules that will help to keep our community healthy.

- Log into your Wildcat Pass each day.
- Be prepared to show your mobile device or a computer printout of your daily Wildcat Pass if asked by a university representative.

Attendance and Lateness: Each class will begin promptly at 1 PM and end at 3:50 PM. **Students are expected to arrive on time, stay for the entire duration of the session, attend every class,** and abide by UNH policies for health testing, mask-wearing, hand-washing, and social distancing. Students attending in person who have tested negative but nonetheless have a fever or otherwise feel ill should not come to class. Because the pandemic impacts us all in many ways, often quite suddenly and unexpectedly, no penalty will be imposed on student grades due to missed class sessions. However, **regular attendance is the foundation for active participation in this class (there are no online discussion boards) and participation will count for one quarter of your final course grade.** If you need to miss a class, please notify me in advance if possible so I am aware of your situation. It is ultimately your responsibility to make up work missed due to absences on your own time. Also, students will still be expected to submit assignments on time. If appropriate, accommodations will be made, based on documented evidence.

Grades: In keeping with UNH's grading system, an **"A" indicates "excellent"** performance, **"B" indicates "superior"** performance, **"C" indicates "competent, acceptable"** performance, **"D" indicates "marginal" performance**, and **"F" indicates "failing"** performance. Intermediate grades (+/-) indicate that work is better in some areas of evaluation than in other areas. Grades will be determined using the following scale:

A (100-92); A- (91-90); B+ (89-88); B (87-82); B- (81-80); C+ (79-78);

C (77-72); C- (71-70); D+ (69-68); D (67-62); D- (61-60); F (59 and below)

Course Requirements:

Participation (25%): For this seminar to work, we must all participate and take responsibility not only for our own learning, but also for the learning of the entire group. To provide you with an indication of how your participation is being assessed, I will assign a mid-semester participation grade at mid-semester. At that time, I will also suggest ways that you might improve your participation if necessary. Class participation will then be reassessed at semester's end and a final average score for participation will be recorded. Class participation will be assessed based primarily on the quantity and quality of contributions in the following areas:

1. **First**, you will be expected to **make active, regular, and on-topic contributions to every week's class discussion**. This may take the form of completing assigned activities, asking questions, requesting clarification of readings, providing examples to illustrate concepts, responding to other students, etc. On some occasions I will distribute questions to guide your reading and you should come to class prepared to share your answers. I may also ask you to come to class prepared with your own list of questions, drawn from specific passages or concepts in the readings, to activate our discussions. The main requirement is that you contribute informed comments and questions, keep an open mind, and respect the thoughts, opinions, and work of others in class.

2. **Second**, I will ask you at certain points in the semester to **work in small groups to lead class discussion**. As part of this, you will summarize assigned course readings and develop at least five questions for each reading to prime class discussion. Questions should reflect understanding of the week's readings, and each question should be substantial enough to support 10-15 minutes of discussion. Class members will be required to read these questions and come prepared to answer them in class. Questions should post to Canvas by midnight the night before class.

3. **Third**, you will **present (10-15 minutes) your final project to class** at semester's end.

Thought Paper (35% total): Each student will write a paper (minimum of 2,000 words) on concepts and theories relating to the course. In keeping with the UNH requirements for writing intensive courses, students are required to provide peer feedback and do a revised version of their first draft. Detailed guidelines will be distributed via Canvas and discussed in class (see Course Outline and Reading Schedule for related due dates). **The first draft is worth 15%, the peer feedback is worth 5%, and the revised draft is worth 15%. Students who do not submit a revised draft, or who submit a revised draft that has only superficial revisions, will receive a zero for that portion of the assignment.**

Research Project (40%): Each student will develop a personal research project on a topic related to communication technologies and culture. Detailed guidelines will be distributed via Canvas and discussed in class. To receive credit, the project must include **all** of the following:

- **Individual conference** (15 minutes) with me
- **Research statement** (250-500 words) including **discussion of possible interests and working bibliography of at least five sources beyond class** (the statement will be emailed to me prior to the conference)
- **Paper** (minimum 2500 words, due at end of semester) and **presentation** (10-15 minutes)

How to submit assignments on Canvas: For work submitted on Canvas, Microsoft Word (.doc/x) or Adobe Portable Document Format (.pdf) documents are required. If you create your work using some other software, such as Apple Pages or Google Docs, use the "save as" or "export" function to save your file as a Word (.doc/x) or PDF document before uploading. Files with extensions other than .doc/x or .pdf will be considered late. Files that are corrupted or that cannot be opened will also be considered late. To upload your file, click on the "assignments" button in the Canvas menu and select the appropriate assignment. Then browse to your file,

attach it, and hit submit. **It is the student's responsibility to confirm that the instructor has received their work. Shortly after the due date, if you see a zero (0) for the assignment in your grades, this informs you that your work has not been received or has been received but cannot be opened.** This means the late paper policy (described below) is now in effect. After you have successfully uploaded your late paper, this "0" will revert to a hyphen (-) to let you know that your work has been received. Once I have finished evaluating your work, this hyphen will change to a new number that reflects your final score on the assignment.

Policy on Late Work: The thought paper is designed to ensure that every student has an equal chance to demonstrate their mastery of a common set of course materials and learning outcomes by completing their first and final drafts within a set timeframe and common framework of peer review. Submitting drafts on time is therefore essential to achieving shared learning outcomes and treating all students equitably. To ensure fairness and encourage timely learning outcomes, thought paper drafts submitted up to 7 days late will be penalized 10 points (e.g. a draft submitted by the following Tuesday at 1 PM that scores a 95 will drop to 85). Drafts submitted after 7 days but before 14 days late will be penalized 20 points (e.g. a 95 drops to 75). **Final research papers** are designed to afford you an opportunity to demonstrate personal mastery of individual research topics by integrating course readings and outside scholarly materials into your own voice and perspective. While submitting research papers on time is important for ensuring that all work is evaluated equitably, individualized learning outcomes can still be fully achieved if the work is submitted late. Therefore, the penalty on late research papers is less strict. Papers submitted after the given due date will be penalized 1 point per day up to a maximum of 14 days (e.g. a paper due at midnight on May 14 that is submitted on May 19 by midnight will receive a 5 point deduction). **After 14 days, late thought papers and research papers will not be accepted except where there are documented reasons to excuse late work or where a course grade of "incomplete" is warranted.** If you think your work is going to be late, please let me know beforehand. Please know that this policy is not intended as punitive. Instead, it seeks to motivate students to manage time effectively and to ensure that each student's work is treated equally and fairly. It also is a way for me to be transparent in informing students about grading practices in the course.

UNH Policy on Academic Honesty: All work for this course must be in full compliance with [UNH policy on academic honesty](#). Violation of this policy will result, minimally, in a failing grade for this course. **Plagiarism includes using someone else's ideas or words without giving them credit.** If you take language and/or ideas from a book, article, or website without telling your reader, you have plagiarized. It can be done consciously or unconsciously; both are unacceptable. **Plagiarism also includes submitting someone else's work as if it were your own**, as in obtaining a paper from another student or from the Internet or paying someone to write a paper on your behalf. **Plagiarism also includes self-plagiarism, which occurs if you submit a paper or portions of a paper written for another class** as if it were original to this class. If you are unsure about what does or does not count as plagiarism, please consult with me and/or review the UNH policy on academic honesty. **Students should also complete the [UNH plagiarism tutorial](#)** for additional guidance on how to properly paraphrase and cite sources. Students should know that UNH uses "Safe Assignment." This service searches the Internet and other databases to compare student essays against sources found online and other papers in the database.

Evaluation Criteria for Student Work: Exams, papers, and video essays will be **evaluated for the quality of their thinking, content, and form.** Excellent work will have ideas that are:

- Clearly and consistently focused on a research question and central thesis that are informed by original and critical thinking about the topic
- Fully explained in themselves, coherently organized, and logically connected to each other in support of a central thesis
- Developed incrementally from point to point using smooth, cohesive transitions
- Substantively and accurately rooted in course readings and outside scholarly research as called for by the assignment

- Consistently supported by specific and well-developed details, reasons, examples, evidence, descriptions, or other forms of explication and proof
- Presented using an original title (in the case of papers and video essays) and framed by a compelling introduction that includes a specific research question and by an effective conclusion that reinforces unity by answering the research question with a strong summation of the thesis
- Nearly error-free in terms of spelling, grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and paragraphing and, in the case of video essays, exceptional in technical mechanics.
- Accurately cited using a standard reference system (e.g. APA or MLA)

Center for Academic Enrichment (CAE): Provides students with services and resources to support their academic success.

Accessibility Services: If you are a student with a documented disability or believe you may have a disability that requires accommodations, please contact Student Accessibility Services. If you think you have a disability requiring accommodations, you must register with the [Disability Services Office](#). The Disability Services Coordinator at UNHM is Jenessa Zurek. Jenessa can be contacted at (603) 641-4383, jenessa.zurek@unh.edu or in person in the Student Services Suite, Room P410H.

Mental Health Support Services: In partnership with The Mental Health Center of Greater Manchester, UNH Manchester offers consultation visits on a walk-in basis in the Academic Advising department (located in the Student Services suites, 4th floor). You may also call ahead to be placed on the walk-in schedule by contacting Academic Advising at (603) 641-4170. Services include:

- Free confidential screening & consultation with a licensed mental health therapist.
- Referrals to mental health or substance misuse treatment, and assistance in understanding how to afford additional treatment (with or without insurance!) or find free services.

If you would like to connect to counseling services directly, you may do so by contacting The Greater Manchester Mental Health Center at (603) 668-4111. If you or someone you know is experiencing a mental health or substance misuse **crisis**, please contact the Mobile Crisis Response Team (MCRT) at (800) 688-3544.

Title IX Confidentiality and Mandatory Reporting: The University of New Hampshire at Manchester and its community are committed to assuring a safe and productive educational environment for all students and for the university as a whole. To this end, the University requires UNH faculty and staff members, hall directors, resident assistants (RAs), and other students employed in leadership, supervisory, and/or mentoring roles [such as Peer Assistant Leaders (PALs), Mentor Ambassadors for Transfer Engagement (MATEs) and the Center for Academic Enrichment (CAE) mentors and tutors] to report to the University's Title IX Coordinator (Donna Marie Sorrentino, dms@unh.edu, 603-862-2930/1527 TTY) any incidents of sexual violence, domestic violence, stalking and harassment shared by students regardless of whether it occurs on or off the Manchester campus. If you wish to speak to a confidential support service provider who does not have this reporting responsibility because their discussions with clients are subject to legal privilege, you can find a list of confidential crisis centers [here](#). Please contact the crisis center that services the town where you live. For more information about what happens when you report, how UNH considers your requests for confidentiality once a report is made to the Title IX Coordinator, your rights and report options at UNH (including anonymous report options) please visit the following webpage: <https://www.unh.edu/affirmativeaction/reporting-students>.

Instructor Availability: My job is to help you to learn so that you can train your thinking and expand your knowledge. I'm passionate about this work and the opportunity it affords to share the joy and power of intellectual pursuit. Please do not hesitate to visit me during office hours to discuss your ideas and review the course materials. You are also welcome to set up an appointment outside of my office hours if that works better

for you. You may also contact me by office phone, via Canvas messaging, or by email (**use your UNH email account only**). I will make every effort to respond within 24 hours.

Course Disruption: In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to change when necessitated by revised course delivery, semester calendar or other circumstances. Information about changes in this course can be obtained at the myCourses site or by contacting me via email. If the course is not able to meet face-to-face students should continue to check myCourses for announcements and updates to this syllabus as needed.

COURSE OUTLINE & READING SCHEDULE

1. **Feb. 2** Introduction to Course

Review Syllabus

In-class video: *Arrival* (Villeneuve, 2016, 116m)

2. **Feb. 9** The First Communication Technology: Language & the Rise of Human Cultures

Yuval Noah Harari, "[The Tree of Knowledge](#)"

Clifford Geertz, "[The Impact of the Concept of Culture on the Concept of Man](#)"

Review thought paper assignment

3. **Feb. 16** Humanities & Social Science Views of Communication & Culture

Wendy Griswold, "[Culture & the Cultural Diamond](#)"

4. **Feb. 23** Time, Space, Communication & Culture

James Carey, "[A Cultural Approach to Communication](#)"

5. **Mar. 2** Communication, Culture & the Public Sphere

James Carey, "[Reconceiving Mass and Media](#)"

L.M. Sacasas, "[The Inescapable Town Square](#)"

6. **Mar. 9** Ways of Knowing: Print Media, Epistemology & Culture

Neil Postman, [*Amusing Ourselves to Death*](#), pp. vii-63

First draft of thought paper due

7. **Mar. 16** Ways of Knowing: Electronic Media, Epistemology & Culture

Neil Postman, [*Amusing Ourselves to Death*](#), pp. 64-163

Peer feedback for thought paper due

Schedule research conferences with me

8. **Mar. 23** Ways of Living: Gender, Relationships & Technology From Plowshares to Dating Apps

Debora L. Spar, *Work Mate Marry Love* (pp. 3-153)

Revised version of thought paper due

9. **Mar. 30** Ways of Living: Gender, Relationships & Technology from Dating Apps To AI

Debora L. Spar, *Work Mate Marry Love* (pp. 154-289)

In-class video: *Her* (Jonze, 2013, 126m)

Individual research conferences meet this week, as scheduled, with me

10. **Apr. 6** Ways of Working: The Aspirational Labor of Social Media Production

Brooke Erin Duffy, [*\(Not\) Getting Paid to do What You Love*](#), pp. ix-135

Student group 1 leads our discussion

Apr. 13 **NO CLASS; FOLLOWS FRIDAY SCHEDULE**

11. **Apr. 20** Ways of Working: The Aspirational Labor of Social Media Production

Brooke Erin Duffy, [*\(Not\) Getting Paid to do What You Love*](#), pp. 136-236

Student group 2 leads our discussion

12. **Apr. 27** Ways of Predicting & Persuading: Marketing, Automation, Big Data & Machine Learning

William Ammerman, [*The Invisible Brand*](#), pp. xi-139

Student group 3 leads our discussion

13. **May 4** Ways of Predicting & Persuading: Marketing, Automation, Big Data & Machine Learning

William Ammerman, [*The Invisible Brand*](#), pp. 143-264

Student group 4 leads our discussion

14. **May. 11** Student Presentations

Oral presentations of research

Final projects due in Canvas Friday May 14 (by midnight)